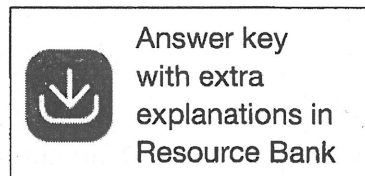


Test 4 answer key

Reading and Use of English



Part 1

1 C 2 B 3 D 4 C 5 D 6 C 7 A 8 B

Part 2

9 made/become 10 so 11 is/was 12 which 13 at 14 with
15 have 16 one

Part 3

17 existence 18 industrial 19 inhabitants 20 inexpensive
21 readily 22 introduction 23 poisonous 24 internationally

Part 4

25 didn't/did not HESITATE | to put/in putting
26 'd/had BETTER | ask
27 with the | EXCEPTION of
28 MIGHT not/n't | have
29 feel LIKE | going
30 UNLESS he | trains harder/more / does more training

Part 5

31 B 32 B 33 C 34 D 35 B 36 A

Part 6

37 F 38 A 39 D 40 B 41 G 42 E

Part 7

43 A 44 B 45 D 46 C 47 A 48 C 49 B 50 D 51 B 52 A

Test 4 answer key

Listening



Answer key
with extra
explanations in
Resource Bank

Part 1

1 B 2 A 3 C 4 B 5 A 6 C 7 C 8 B

Part 2

9 One thousand five hundred / 1,500 10 fruit 11 blind
12 (a) mine / (an old) mine 13 pear 14 pond 15 masks
16 map 17 (outdoor) lights 18 communicate

Part 3

19 H 20 A 21 E 22 C 23 G

Part 4

24 A 25 A 26 C 27 B 28 A 29 B 30 C

Audioscript

Test Four.

This is the B2 First for Schools Listening test.

I'm going to give you the instructions for this test. I'll introduce each part of the test and give you time to look at the questions. At the start of each piece you'll hear this sound:

tone

You will hear each piece twice.

Remember, while you are listening, write your answers on the question paper. You'll have five minutes at the end of the test to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet.

There will now be a pause. Please ask any questions now, because you must not speak during the test.

[pause]

Now open your question paper and look at Part One.

[pause]

PART 1

You will hear people talking in eight different situations. For questions 1 to 8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Question 1 *You hear a girl talking about a television studio she visited on a school trip.*

[pause]

tone

Boy: How was the trip to the television studio?

Girl: Interesting! When we first went in, there were people everywhere all doing different stuff as you might expect. We went round several sections, like the room where they broadcast news programmes from. That looks so smart on screen, but you can't imagine how many cables and things were just lying around on the floor. We also watched some actors filming scenes from a new drama, but they didn't seem to notice we were there. We waved to them but they didn't wave back. They were probably just busy.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 2 *You hear a girl talking to her father about her career plans.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: I think I'd like to become an engineer like you, Dad. Do you think that's a sensible idea?

Boy: Well, you're good at maths and practical too, so it might be an excellent choice. Have you spoken to a careers advisor at school about whether there are any particular skills you should have to give yourself a chance?

Girl: Yes, and he suggested trying to find a summer holiday job in an engineering company. Would that be sensible, do you think?

Boy: Possibly, but there're so many different engineering jobs. It'd make sense first to research the various openings that are available and think about where you'd ultimately want to end up.

Girl: I think I'd like to become an engineer like you, dad. Do you think that's a sensible idea?

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 4 answer key

Question 3

You hear a boy telling a friend about his new phone.

[pause]

tone

Girl: That's a cool phone, George!

Boy: Yes, I just got an upgrade yesterday. It's such a relief because the battery life on my old one was dreadful. I seemed to be charging it every five minutes. Apparently this one doesn't have that issue, but I haven't had time to check that out yet, of course.

Girl: Well if it's as cool as it looks, you'll be fine!

Boy: I'm not at all sure it will be. I'm having some problems syncing it with all my contacts. I can't get my head round the instructions. Can you see if you can work out what they mean?

Girl: Sure. I wish I could afford something so smart!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 4

You hear two friends talking about a game called Sokatira.

[pause]

Girl: Brilliant sports lesson today, playing that game from Spain – Sokatira, it was called, right?

Boy: Yeah – where two teams pull against each other on either end of a rope.

Girl: Our team kept winning, pulling you lot over the centre line!

Boy: I know! I thought I might find it tricky keeping everything we had to do in my head, like when we play football or cricket – actually it was pretty straightforward. Not easy in practice though – you need a bit of muscle. But you did well.

Girl: It was a bit of a struggle – I was exhausted by the end of it! But it was definitely really enjoyable.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 5 *You hear two friends talking about something called the Paleo diet.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: I enjoyed that lesson about the Paleo diet.

Boy: Where you just eat the kind of things that people used to hunt or gather before the development of agriculture? It seems to make sense to me – no processed food, everything's natural and you know exactly what's going into your body. There were arguments against it, though – it can be bad for bone health cos you're not getting complex carbohydrates and you're consuming too much meat. But then, our teacher did say research indicates that people in ancient times actually ate more plants and grains and less meat than fans of the diet often imagine.

Girl: That's interesting!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 6 *You hear two friends talking about a pop concert.*

[pause]

tone

Girl: How about going to the concert on Friday? My dad's offered to drive us there.

Boy: I'm not sure. I've got loads of homework, and the line-up looks disappointing – those groups didn't get great reviews last time they played here.

Girl: But live music's great. I know the tickets are pricey, but we could pay less if we sat at the back.

Boy: The view's bad from there, and have you forgotten the concert hall is in the middle of town? Last time it took ages to get away after the show.

Girl: And I remember it was virtually impossible to get to. Shall we give it a miss?

Boy: Fine.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 4 answer key

- Question 7** *You hear two friends talking about a TV series.*
[pause]
tone
- Boy: Have you been watching that series about the American girl in Paris?
Girl: It's brilliant, isn't it! But I can't understand why the reviews of it have been so awful.
Boy: I know. They go on and on about it being full of stereotypes, which is true, I guess, but isn't that missing the point?
Girl: It's really just a bit of harmless fun. It didn't set out to be a documentary though it's got a bit of social comment.
Boy: Yes, I don't know why most reviews don't compare it to other stuff the director's done.
Girl: There are lots of really obvious similarities!
[pause]
tone
[The recording is repeated.]
[pause]
- Question 8** *You hear a girl telling a friend about a favour she's doing for her grandfather.*
[pause]
- Girl: I can't meet you until ten tomorrow morning.
Boy: Why's that?
Girl: I've got to go to my granddad's house. I promised I'd do him a favour while he's away on holiday. He's got a plastic container called a rain gauge in his garden. Every morning at nine he measures how much rain's fallen into it. Then he posts the figures to a website that research scientists use.
Boy: Doesn't sound hard.
Girl: No. I feel guilty, though. I got distracted when he explained exactly what I had to do and the first two times I went there, I forgot to replace a tube that goes in the container. So, the measurements I took weren't right.
[pause]
tone
[The recording is repeated.]
[pause]
That is the end of Part One.
Now turn to Part Two.

PART 2

You will hear a teenager called Ben giving a presentation about his interest in bats. For questions 9 to 18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have forty-five seconds to look at Part Two.

[pause]

tone

Hello. My name's Ben, and my friends call me Ben the Batman because of my interest in bats, which I'm talking to you about today.

Let me start with some facts. Out of one hundred and seven species of mammals found here in the UK where I live, eighteen of those species are bats. And it's been estimated that there are four thousand five hundred different species of mammals on our planet, of which one thousand five hundred – more than you might expect – are bats. Compare that with just two hundred and sixty species of monkeys!

People in the UK generally don't know much about bats or what they believe they know is often wrong – about their diet, for example. The main source of food for bats, both globally and in the UK, is insects, but I've heard claims that bats here eat fruit, which is understandable but isn't the case. In some countries, certain species of bat live off fish, mainly from rivers.

Until a couple of years ago, I knew very little about bats – maybe because they're very shy, with humans, anyway. Traditionally, they're regarded as quite frightening creatures, perhaps because of how strange-looking they are, and one common idea about them – and one I used to share, although false, is that they're blind. Actually, they have extremely good vision.

The best place to see lots of bats together is probably a cave – that's where I'd go if I was looking for them now. My first sight of them though was when my family went on a tour around an old mine. At one point, the guide shone his torch at a massive group of bats all just hanging from a rock. It was amazing and soon after that I started reading about bats in a fascinating book I found.

I now know there are several places in my neighbourhood where one species called the Greater Horseshoe Bat can be found. For an idea of how small it is, think of a pear – though another UK species are even smaller – about the size of a golf ball. Bats do vary, though – I've seen one recently that was as big as a large rat.

Unfortunately, bat populations are in serious decline. I belong to a conservation group, and we're trying to make the area around my school more bat-friendly. We have a shed where I've seen some bats – it has a special roof where they can shelter. And we now have a pond, where they can get water – several students were involved in digging that, myself included.

We also have competitions at school to encourage bat conservation. For a recent one, we designed posters of bats – some were extremely impressive – and last year, we did masks – that was very successful in terms of student commitment. We also had one which required us to put together wooden bat boxes – that were fixed onto fences for bats to use as resting places.

I've also been involved in setting up a local 'bat walk'. The aim's to guide people around places where bats can be observed. An information pack was created for it, including a map – that was my contribution – and there's a video showing different parts of the walk. Quite a few people have done the walk now.

Test 4 answer key

Making gardens more bat-friendly is a really positive thing to do. Bats love certain kinds of trees and flowers, but at night, they avoid places that aren't dark, so outdoor lights are the worst things if you're aiming to encourage bats to visit. Not having night-time barbecues can help too – any human activities frighten bats – and it's good to keep cats inside at night because they hunt bats.

I'd like to be a bat researcher when I'm older. There are many things about bats that need further investigation – how they fly, for example, which has always interested me, or how they communicate, which is what I'd focus on ideally. Another area that needs more study is how bats form relationships within the species. Basically, there's still so much we don't know about these amazing creatures.

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Two again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Two.

Now turn to Part Three.

PART 3

You will hear five extracts in which teenagers are talking about a transport survey they did in town as part of a school project. For questions 19 to 23, choose from the list (A to H) what the speaker says about the activity. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have thirty seconds to look at Part Three.

[pause]

tone

Speaker 1

We did a geography project at school today where we worked in groups, surveying people at our local train station. We had to find out about their journey – where they'd been or were going, the reason for their trip, things like that. We thought we wouldn't have long enough. Actually, we did and it was definitely different from our usual lessons. Even so, I generally prefer it when we stay in our classroom. My job was to keep a record of the answers we received. That kind of task suits me, and I think I did it well. Most of what we discovered was fairly predictable but that's interesting too, I suppose.

[pause]

Speaker 2

I was in a group where most people felt uncomfortable having to bother strangers with questions when they were trying to catch a train. I didn't mind doing that as we always gave them a chance to say they didn't have time to talk to us if that's how they felt. I was actually amazed how many people were willing to stop and chat. Most of their answers were more or less what we'd expected. The only issue I had was working out the best way to note down all the things they told us. We had no clear guidelines, but I came up with my own system which seemed to work.

[pause]

Speaker 3

Our geography project was cool. I was a bit anxious at first as I've never done anything like that before and I was afraid most people'd be annoyed at being stopped by us. But once we started, I really got into it and couldn't believe how soon it was time to head back to the classroom. The teacher had explained exactly how to go about the task – it was quite complicated. My job in our group was to keep track of everyone we'd spoken to, trying to ensure we covered a representative sample of ages and genders, for example. All in all, we concluded it was useful and fun.

[pause]

Speaker 4

Our group really enjoyed the experience. My job was to try to get an overview of what was happening at the station, recording total numbers of people passing in and out, classifying them by age and gender – that sort of thing. The five of us in our group each did it independently and then we compared our results after one hour exactly. They were pretty similar, which was reassuring. It was brilliant doing something so different from what we usually do in class – though I must say I was glad I wasn't one of the people who had to stop busy travellers to bother them with questions.

[pause]

Test 4 answer key

Speaker 5

[pause]

The teacher told our group to try to survey at least fifty people in the hour that we had outside the station. We managed it with just two minutes to spare. I initially thought we had to speak to equal numbers of men and women but fortunately I'd got that wrong as for some reason there were far more women around at that time. In our group we worked in pairs with one person asking the questions and the other noting down the responses. We swapped over after each interview which was good as it gave us a break from writing down the information – that was quite a pressured task.

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Three again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Three.

Now turn to Part Four.

PART 4

You will hear teenage cyclist Joe Anderson talking about his racing career in cycling so far. For questions 24 to 30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part Four.

[pause]

tone

Interviewer: Seventeen-year-old Joe Anderson's been taking part in cycling races since he was 14, and he's here to talk about his sport. Joe, was choosing to take up cycling an obvious thing to do?

Joe: My family all have a passion for triathlon – that's where you swim, cycle and run in the same race. Although I wasn't as into it as them, I did put more work into cycling partly because I once heard Dad say to my brother that it was my weakest skill. But I quickly realised the pleasure I got from it had become more important than anything else and I made up my mind I'd focus on it. When I decided to give up the idea of doing triathlon my brother tried to persuade me not to, but he's OK with it now.

Interviewer: How did you feel after taking part in your first major race?

Joe: I was 14. The other cyclists were older and all looked fitter and more up for it than me! They weren't chatty, either, which made me rather uncomfortable. In fact, I nearly didn't bother to start! But then coming third was a deciding point, especially when the winner congratulated me. It made me want to see what I was capable of, although looking back I was probably a bit naive at the time.

Interviewer: So do you take part in different kinds of cycling races?

Joe: In winter, I have to do road racing with my team. In summer, though, there are time trials – you race alone against the clock, trying to get the fastest time. So they aren't team competitions, and I usually do well because I can push myself to my limit, which is why I look forward to them most. I sometimes do track races that are also short and fast, but I've never had great results in them, which is disappointing. I know there's supposed to be a thrill in racing round with lots of other cyclists, though I don't get it!

Interviewer: Have you ever been to any kind of summer camp for cyclists?

Joe: I went to a summer camp before I got into racing, just for fun. I recommend it for anyone wondering about taking up cycling as a sport, but not for those already racing. Lots of things were great – like we went on long rides, learned about bike handling and maintenance, and how to go round corners safely. There wasn't any specific coaching in racing techniques, and everyone at the camp had different abilities.

Interviewer: What's the worst problem you've come up against so far?

Joe: Well, there are complicated race tactics to get your head round, though I like that. One big thing you need to know in order to be a winner is how and when to brake – like if you do it when you don't have to, you need more effort to get going again, and if you don't do it at the right time, it's dangerous. I didn't really get that and last year I fell off and damaged my knee; it was extremely tough psychologically because I wasn't able to race for a while.

Interviewer: How's your training programme going at the moment?

Joe: There's so much more to it than you might think, and not everyone would want to put in the long hours that I do. I try to do strength exercises in the gym, though not as often as my coach would probably expect 'cos they're pretty dull and it's hard to see any immediate benefit which doesn't help. I don't regard anything I have to do off the bike with much enthusiasm, to be honest!

Test 4 answer key

Interviewer: Getting your priorities right must be tough at the moment.

Joe: I've still got to keep up with academic stuff. Most teachers are understanding if I hand things in late, but the pressure of deadlines does get me down. I know what I want to achieve in cycling, though, and I know that there aren't any guarantees. So, I have to focus, because if I get it wrong now, I might not make it. It'd be great to join in with all the things my schoolmates are doing but that's not an option.

Interviewer: Thanks, Joe – and good luck!

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Four again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Four.

There will now be a pause of five minutes for you to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet. Be sure to follow the numbering of all the questions. I'll remind you when there's one minute left, so that you're sure to finish in time.

[pause – four minutes]

You have one more minute left.

[pause – one minute]

That's the end of the test. Please stop now. Your supervisor will now collect all the question papers and answer sheets.